14.8 Abdominal Trauma*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "My abdomen hurts after the accident." **Objective** • Distended, bruised abdomen • BP 90/56 mmHg, HR 122/min • Free fluid in the abdomen on ultrasound	**ACTUAL** Inadequate fluid volume related to internal hemorrhage as evidenced by hypotension, tachycardia and free intraperitoneal fluid.	• Vital signs stable before and after surgery.	• Insert two large-bore cannulas. • Give fluids and blood as prescribed. • Nil by mouth; prepare for laparotomy. • Follow vital signs, abdominal girth and urine output.	• Outcome reached when hemodynamics are stable.
Subjective • Rates pain 8/10 **Objective** • Guarding and rebound tenderness	**ACTUAL** Acute pain related to abdominal injury as evidenced by a pain score of 8/10 and guarding.	• Pain bearable (4/10 or less) after assessment and treatment.	• Give analgesia as prescribed once the surgeon has examined him. • Let him lie with his knees bent. • Reassess often.	• Considered met when pain is tolerable.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Bowel may be injured	**RISK** Risk for infection as evidenced by risk factors: possible bowel perforation and peritoneal contamination.	• No peritonitis or wound infection.	• Give antibiotics as prescribed. • Watch temperature and abdominal signs. • Report increasing pain or rigidity.	• Goal reached if no infection develops.

*References for this care plan: [2], [35], [128]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.